

SUPERIOR COURT OF CALIFORNIA
COUNTY OF SAN FRANCISCO
UNIFIED FAMILY COURT

SHERIE MARIE SORENSEN,

Petitioner

VS.

JACOB ERIK SORENSEN,

Respondent

) Case Number: FDI-25-801143

) Hearing Date: April 28, 2026

) Hearing Time: 9:00 AM

) Department: 404

) Presiding: DONNA PETRE

OTHER REVIEW HEARING

TENTATIVE RULING

The parties are ordered to appear. The parties may appear in person in Department 404 or remotely by Zoom Video. If a party chooses to appear by video, that party must abide by the Notice and Instructions for Remote Appearance in San Francisco Family Court set forth above.

Having read and considered the pleadings, declarations, and other evidence submitted in this matter, the Court makes the following findings and orders:

A. Procedural History

- 1) On December 16, 2025, the Respondent Jacob Sorensen filed a Request for Order for Joint Legal and Physical Custody of Gianna Sorensen (DOB 04/27/2011) and the two family dogs, Roxie and Brookie. The father requests family therapy with his daughter.
- 2) The matter was heard on February 2, 2026, and the parties were sent to mediation with a return date of March 19, 2026.
- 3) On March 6, 2026, the Mother filed a Responsive Declaration with accompanying Points and Authorities to the Father's Request for Order. In the Response, the Mother consented to joint legal custody and sole physical custody of Gianna.

- 1 4) She consented that the father and Gianna would engage in individual therapy in lieu of family
2 therapy and that the therapy would not be terminated until mutually agreed between both parents
3 and/or the recommendation of the therapist. She opposed joint legal and physical custody orders
4 for the two dogs since they are personal property and should be considered as part of the overall
5 division of their property.
- 6 5) On March 12, 2026, the Father filed a Reply Declaration requesting joint legal and physical
7 custody of Gianna as well as family therapy in conjunction with individual therapy.
- 8 6) On March 19, 2026, the Court held this matter and issued the following orders:
- 9 a. Minor shall continue with the current individual therapy
- 10 b. Both parties shall participate in co-parenting counseling. The parties shall split the cost.
- 11 c. The parties shall have Joint Legal custody of the Minor
- 12 d. Physical custody is granted to the Mother.
- 13 e. No visitation time is granted to the Father at this time
- 14 f. Mother shall provide weekly updates to the Father on Minor's general well-being
- 15 g. The Court reserved on dog issue and this will be revisited at a future hearing.
- 16 h. There shall be no disparagement by one parent of the other parent to or in front of the
17 minor child.
- 18 i. The matter was continued for a Review Hearing in Department 404 on April 28, 2026
- 19 7) On April 23, 2026, the Mother filed a Declaration regarding the Review Hearing. In this
20 declaration the Mother states that Gianna is in therapy and the parties have not been able to begin
21 co-parent counseling.
- 22 8) On April 24, 2026, the Father filed a Declaration regarding the Review Hearing the Father
23 requests:
- 24 a. Reunification therapy begin with his daughter, and she continue with her individual
25 therapy.
- 26 b. Mother to provide more substance in her updates on Gianna including information on
27 school and general well-being.
- 28 c. That Esther Martino be appointed as their co-parent counselor
- 29 d. Deny Tier II evaluation

1 e. Joint custody of the two family dogs.

2 **B. Findings and Order**

3 1) This court has jurisdiction to make child custody orders in this case under the Uniform Child
4 Custody Jurisdiction and Enforcement Act. A violation of this order may subject the party in
5 violation to civil or criminal penalties, or both. The country of habitual residence of the minor
6 child(ren) is the United States,

7 2) **The parties are ordered to appear. The parties may appear in person in Department 404 or**
8 **remotely by Zoom Video. If a party chooses to appear by video, that party must abide by**
9 **the Notice and Instructions for Remote Appearance in San Francisco Family Court set**
10 **forth above.**